

Excel Formulas Tab

30 Multiple-Choice Questions | Basic to Advanced

1. What symbol must every Excel formula begin with?

- A) @
- B) =
- C) #
- D) \$

2. Which tab in the Excel ribbon contains the Function Library, Defined Names, and Formula Auditing groups?

- A) Insert
- B) Data
- C) Formulas
- D) Review

3. What does the formula =A1+A2 do?

- A) Multiplies A1 and A2
- B) Adds the values in A1 and A2
- C) Divides A1 by A2
- D) Compares A1 and A2

4. Which button lets you quickly sum a column of numbers without typing SUM yourself?

- A) AutoSum (Σ)
- B) Quick Fill
- C) Insert Function
- D) Name Box

5. Which function returns the average of a range of numbers?

- A) =TOTAL()
- B) =AVERAGE()
- C) =MEAN()
- D) =SUM()

6. What does the COUNT function do?

- A) Counts cells containing numbers
- B) Adds all numbers in a range
- C) Counts all non-empty cells
- D) Finds the largest number

7. Which function counts non-empty cells, including text?

- A) COUNT
- B) COUNTA
- C) COUNTIF
- D) SUM

8. What does the MAX function return?

- A) The smallest value in a range
- B) The average of a range
- C) The largest value in a range
- D) The count of values

9. Which symbol is used to lock a row or column reference so it doesn't change when copied?

- A) #
- B) &
- C) \$
- D) %

10. In the reference \$A\$1, what type of reference is this?

- A) Relative reference
- B) Absolute reference
- C) Mixed reference
- D) External reference

11. If cell C1 has the formula =A1+B1 and is copied to C2, what does C2 contain (default relative references)?

- A) =A1+B1
- B) =A2+B2
- C) =\$A\$1+\$B\$1
- D) An error

12. What does the IF function do?

- A) Looks up a value in a table
- B) Tests a condition and returns one value if true, another if false
- C) Counts cells matching a condition
- D) Rounds a number

13. Which group on the Formulas tab lets you insert functions organized by category (Financial, Logical, Text, etc.)?

- A) Function Library
- B) Defined Names

- C) Formula Auditing
- D) Calculation

14. What does the CONCATENATE (or CONCAT) function do?

- A) Splits text into multiple cells
- B) Joins two or more text strings into one
- C) Converts text to numbers
- D) Counts characters in text

15. Which function would you use to look up a value in the first column of a table and return a value in the same row from another column?

- A) HLOOKUP
- B) VLOOKUP
- C) INDEX
- D) MATCH

16. What does the TODAY() function return?

- A) The current time only
- B) The current date
- C) The date the workbook was created
- D) A fixed date that never changes

17. Which feature lets you assign a meaningful name (like 'TaxRate') to a cell or range for use in formulas?

- A) Name Manager
- B) AutoFill
- C) Conditional Formatting
- D) Data Validation

18. What is a named range primarily used for?

- A) Formatting cells automatically
- B) Making formulas easier to read and maintain by using names instead of cell addresses
- C) Sorting data alphabetically
- D) Creating charts

19. Which Formula Auditing tool draws arrows to the cells that supply values used in the selected cell's formula?

- A) Trace Dependents
- B) Trace Precedents
- C) Error Checking
- D) Watch Window

20. Which Formula Auditing tool shows which cells contain formulas that reference the currently selected cell?

- A) Trace Precedents
- B) Trace Dependents
- C) Evaluate Formula
- D) Show Formulas

21. What does 'Remove Arrows' do in the Formula Auditing group?

- A) Deletes the formulas from cells
- B) Clears the tracer arrows drawn by Trace Precedents/Dependents
- C) Removes named ranges
- D) Deletes comments

22. What does the Error Checking tool help you do?

- A) Format numbers as currency
- B) Identify and troubleshoot common formula errors
- C) Sort a range of data
- D) Merge cells

23. Which tool lets you step through a nested formula one calculation at a time to see intermediate results?

- A) Watch Window
- B) Evaluate Formula
- C) Show Formulas
- D) Name Manager

24. What does the Watch Window let you do?

- A) Monitor the value of specific cells even when they're off-screen or on another sheet
- B) Automatically fix formula errors
- C) Record a macro of formula changes
- D) Protect formulas from editing

25. What keyboard shortcut toggles 'Show Formulas' view in Excel?

- A) Ctrl+`
- B) Ctrl+F
- C) Ctrl+Shift+F
- D) Alt+F1

26. In the Calculation Options group, what does setting calculation mode to 'Manual' do?

- A) Disables all formulas
- B) Excel only recalculates formulas when you press F9 or trigger it manually

- C) Formulas recalculate only when the file is closed
- D) Formulas are converted to static values

27. What does the error value #REF! typically indicate?

- A) A formula is referencing a cell that no longer exists (e.g., it was deleted)
- B) The formula has a typo in a function name
- C) The result is too large to display
- D) Text was used where a number was expected

28. What does the #DIV/0! error mean?

- A) A formula is trying to divide by zero or an empty cell
- B) A reference is invalid
- C) A function name is misspelled
- D) A circular reference exists

29. What is a circular reference in Excel?

- A) A reference to a cell on another worksheet
- B) A formula that directly or indirectly refers back to its own cell
- C) A named range that spans multiple sheets
- D) A reference that uses absolute addressing

30. Which array-capable function, often paired with MATCH, is considered more flexible than VLOOKUP because it can look in either direction (left or right)?

- A) SUMIF
- B) INDEX
- C) COUNTIF
- D) IFERROR

Answer Key

Q#	Answer	Q#	Answer	Q#	Answer
1	B	2	C	3	B
4	A	5	B	6	A
7	B	8	C	9	C
10	B	11	B	12	B
13	A	14	B	15	B
16	B	17	A	18	B
19	B	20	B	21	B
22	B	23	B	24	A
25	A	26	B	27	A
28	A	29	B	30	B